7 days / 6 nights Ethiopa

Day 1 - Addis Ababa

Visit Trinity Cathedral, resting place of Emperor Haile Selassie. Tour the Ethnographic Museum, a great introduction to Ethiopian culture and history. Make a short drive to Entoto Hills for a view of the city and visit Maryam Church. En-route, stop at Sheromeda traditional cloth market. Visit the Mercato or the Sholla Market, two of Addis Ababa's main markets.

Day 2 - Addis Ababa - Bahar Dar

Fly to Bahar Dar on Ethiopian Airlines. Take a boat tour on Lake Tana, the source of the Blue Nile, and tour ancient monasteries on the Zege Peninsula. We will visit two of the following monasteries: Ura Kidane Mehiret, Azwa Maryam, Mehal Zege Giorgis, and Bete Maryam. End the day with a sunset visit to Bezawit Hills overlooking the Nile River.
Overnight Lodge (B, L, D included)
Photographer
The ceiling of Debre Birhan Selassie.

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Day 3 - Bahar Dar - Gondar

Drive through the countryside to Gondar. Tour the Royal Enclosure, a UNESCO World Heritage site featuring five castles built by a succession of Ethiopian kings beginning in the early 17th century.Having survived several wars, including air raids during World War 2, the castles are a testament to the resilience of this once mighty empire. Visit the church of Debre Birhan Selassie, famous for its religious art and especially its iconic ceiling depicting angels.
Overnight Hotel (B, L, D)
Orthodox priest in Lalibela.
Orthodox priest in Lalibela.

Day 4 - Gondar - Lalibela

Fly to Lalibela on Ethiopian Airlines. Tour the magnificent rock-hewn churches, a UNESCO World Heritage site. This group of eleven monolithic churches were carved directly into the stone mountainside at least 800 years ago. This complex boasts the largest monolithic church in the world, a maze of passageways and tunnels, intricately carved reliefs, and fabulous examples of icon paintings. In the late afternoon, enjoy a traditional coffee ceremony and learn the process for baking injera (a staple food for much of Ethiopia.)
Overnight Hotel (B, L, D)
Photographer
Mt. Asheton, Lalibela.

Day 5 - Lalibela

For the morning we have two options: Take a morning hike with mules to the 13th century rock-hewn monastery of Mount Asheton. The walk provides wonderful views of Lalibela and the surrounding countryside. - OR - Drive to Yemrehanna Kristos, a beautiful church situated in a shallow cave that predates the churches of Lalibela. The drive to Yemrehanna will give you the opportunity to view the rural countryside and villages of the Ethiopian highlands. Following either option above continue with tour of Lalibela's churches in the afternoon.
Overnight Hotel (B, L, D)
Photographer
Axum's Saturday basket market.

Day 6 - Lalibela - Axum

Fly to Axum on Ethiopian Airlines. Tour the ancient stelae fields, standing for 2000 years. Visit the new and impressive Archeological Museum. See St. Mary Tsion Church, which houses the Ark of the Covenant according to the Ethiopian Orthodox Church (no one is allowed to see the Ark.) Visit other tombs and archeological sites as time permits.
Overnight Hotel (B, L, D).

Axum - Addis Ababa

Fly to Addis Ababa.Visit the National Museum, home of the 3 million year old skeleton "Lucy." Optional souvenir shopping in the afternoon. Farewell dinner at a traditional Ethiopian restaurant featuring dancers and musicians representing some of the country's many ethnic groups.Transfer to airport for late night departure if needed.
Overnight Hotel (B, L, D).

Tour Includes:

-Entrance fees for all sites and parks mentioned in the itinerary.
-All excursions listed on the itinerary.
-Experienced, multilingual tour guides and guides' expenses
-Ground transportation via tour vehicle (including driver and fuel).
-All domestic flights listed on itinerary (actual flight number/schedule may change).
-All meals mentioned on itinerary.
-Lodging for each night on tour.
-All hotel/airport transfers during the tour.

Tour Excludes:

Any expenses of a personal nature.

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